

Backend Networking Cheat Sheet (v3)

Big Picture

Client → HTTP Request → IP + Port → Operating System → Node.js/Express → Route → Business Logic → Database → HTTP Response → Client

Networking vs Application Layer

Networking layer (IP + Port): 'Which application should receive this request?'

Application layer (Route + HTTP Method): 'Which piece of code inside that application should handle it?'

GET vs POST

GET retrieves existing resources. POST submits data for processing or creates resources. Methods are always from the CLIENT perspective.

Concept Summary

Concept	Responsibility	Example
IP	Find the computer	192.168.1.10
Port	Find the application	8000
Route	Find the code/function	/predict
HTTP Method	Tell the function what operation is requested	GET, POST